

2.1.3 Hinduism

Belief about deity

Nature of God(s)

- Religious pluralism
- God as the ultimate reality manifesting as the universe (Brahman) and as mankind (Atman)
- God as a Super personality
- Brahman as personal and impersonal, with and without form
- Individual deities (Gods and Goddesses) and the different ways in which they are understood
- The Trimurti and the importance to some of the Goddess

Belief in God(s)

- Reasons given in support of belief (religious and spiritual experience including meditation and the authority of the sacred texts)

Miracles

- Concept of miracles, including different beliefs within the religion
- God intervening in the world through:
 - Avatars
 - Krishna and Rama
 - Living avatars
- The rationale for avatars
- The role and significance of miracles

Religious and spiritual experience

Public and private worship

- Concept of worship
- Puja in a mandir and at home
- The use and significance of symbolism in puja, arti and murtis
- Ways in which symbols are used to express belief
- Use of art, music and drama to reflect beliefs

Prayer and meditation

- Concept of prayer and meditation
- The role and importance of prayer and meditation
- Bhakti
- Meditation as a path to moksha and jnana
- Importance of prayer, puja and devotion

Food and fasting

- Concept of fasting
- Use of food and fasting in response to the divine
- Food for festivals and puja (including prashad)
- Fasting and asceticism

The end of life

Body and soul

- Concept of soul
 - The relationship between the body and atman
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Life after death

- Concept of life after death
- In relation to life after death, understanding of:
 - Karma
 - Samsara
 - Moksha
- Relationship between moral behaviour including dharma and varnashramadharma and future rebirths
- Action in this life affects the next life
- Moksha as an ultimate goal
- Disinterested or unattached action

Funeral rites

- Funeral rites in the UK and India
- The ways funeral rites reflect belief and aim to support the bereaved